

FinePix S1800

Features

- Dimensions: 110.2x73.4x81.4 mm³
- Weight: Approx. 337 gm (excluding accessories, battery and memory card)
- Resolution: 12.2 megapixels
- Optical zoom: 18x; Fujinon lens
- LCD screen: 7.6cm (3-inch), approx. 230,000 dots, colour LCD monitor, approx. 97 per cent coverage for shooting, and 100 per cent coverage for playback
- HD movie recording: Yes
- Others: SR auto and face detection, high-performance shooting functions, easy-to-use shooting modes

Price: ₹ 13,999



a camera.

Several types of batteries are in use for digital cameras. There are AA-size, non-rechargeable alkaline, disposable lithium, rechargeable nickel-cadmium (NiCd), rechargeable nickel-metal hydride (NiMH), high-capacity disposable and proprietary rechargeable batteries.

Battery life is a debatable issue and usually there is no guarantee. So it is advisable to carry an extra set of batteries on a trip.

Video recording

Cameras these days are video-enabled. To capture good-quality videos, check whether you can autofocus while shooting or not. Also check video-editing software and memory card specifications. You would require an SDHC card for high-speed video capture.

HD movie recording. There are a number of cameras now that can record high-definition (HD) videos as well. HD visuals contain over two million pixels, making the video four times more detailed than what you are used to seeing on a standard-definition screen.

Shooting modes

Shooting modes come in handy both for personal as well as professional

photographers. Most digital cameras feature macro mode, movie mode, manual mode and continuous mode. Scene modes include portrait, landscape, night scene, sports, candlelight and ski.

Sweep Panorama mode. Sweep Panorama technology will allow you to take breathtaking shots of large landscapes like a never-ending horizon or mountain ranges. Sweep your camera across the landscape to 224 degrees, to get a picture that otherwise would never have come in a single shot.

Low-light performance. A highly sensitive CMOS sensor means you can take excellent shots even in minimal lighting. It also keeps the noise to minimum.

Others

Find out whether the camera is compatible with your computer, printer, memory card, USB drive, etc. Also check the size of the LCD screen. The screen provides digital display of the

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image instantly, so you can review the images and delete the ones you do not like.

How important are megapixels?

Traditional cameras use films to record images. But in digital cameras, the film is replaced with a small sensor chip—either CCD (charge-coupled device) or CMOS (complementary metal-oxide semiconductor)—which stores the image in a digital format. The surface of the CCD or CMOS sensor is divided into tiny squares called pixels. Each pixel records one segment of an image. The more the pixels in a sensor, the more the details it can record.

A megapixel refers to one million pixels, and indicates the resolution capability of digital cameras. There is an entire range of cameras with 1.9 to 14 MP and above. Picture quality doesn't necessarily improve with pixels alone. Other features like lens, colour filter used on the sensor and digital image processor too play an important role. Of course, a high MP rating gives you the flexibility to take sharp prints in large photo sizes like 28x36, 30x48 and 41x61 cm².

Latest trends

The market is flooded with higher-megapixel cameras featuring smile detection/face detection, digital image stabilisation, auto red-eye removal and the capability to shoot high-definition videos. 3D, built-in HDR imaging and more stylish bodies are the latest trends. 3D technology adds third dimension to imaging, allowing you to capture life-like images.

To sum up

Don't go just by the looks of a camera. Make sure it has the right features for your needs. Optical zoom, sensor and megapixels are some of the main features to be considered. Look for convenience features depending on your budget. ●

The author is executive editor at EFY